India By Numbers

Collecting Bihar's Public Data

Task 3 report: what we collected, what it shows, and what comes next

Project	India By Numbers: Public Finance and Demographics, Bihar
Task	Task 3: Data collection
Date	13 November 2026
Submitted by	_____

721	12 of 41	5 years	All
official data files collected	Bihar sources with data collected	of state accounts, cross-checked	files kept exactly as published

1. Executive summary

Task 3 was to gather the actual data behind the Bihar sources we identified in Tasks 1 and 2. We have now collected **721 official files** from **12 of the 41 Bihar sources**: the state's accounts, budget and Economic Survey, GST statistics, Finance Commission reports, Census 2011 (down to every village), and official birth and death statistics. Every file is kept exactly as the government published it, with a record of where and when it was obtained.

Key points

- **The financial data is reliable.** Bihar's monthly accounts, its audited annual accounts and the Economic Survey give the same figures for every year we checked.
- **A first look already raises questions.** Revenue grew about 10% a year from 2021-22 to 2025-26, but salaries, pensions and interest rose from 37% to 47% of revenue, and borrowing reached Rs 63,803 crore in 2025-26. About 57% of the state's revenue comes from the Centre.
- **25 sources still need work.** 11 failed because of problems on the government websites (websites marked "not secure", websites that do not open from outside India, or that only allow a person to download). 14 need someone to log in, fill a form or save on-screen reports. A further 4 sources have nothing to collect.
- **The collection can be repeated at any time** to pick up new releases, and the remaining sources can be added without redoing any of the work.

At a glance

	Result
Official data files collected	721
Bihar sources with data	12 of 41 (1 partly)
Pages of reports made searchable	14,905
Spreadsheet tables available for analysis	3,488
Sources blocked by website problems	11
Sources needing a person to download	14
Sources with nothing to collect	4

2. What the task was and why it matters

India By Numbers aims to bring scattered government information together so that Bihar's public finances and population can be understood as a whole. Today the information sits in dozens of separate websites and reports. Tasks 1 and 2 listed the 41 Bihar sources and assessed how complete each one is. Task 3 collects the data itself, so that it can be analysed and connected.

The task set five conditions, all of which are met:

Condition	What we did
Keep the original files	Every file is stored exactly as published and locked against changes.
Record when each file was downloaded	The date and time of every download is recorded.
Record where each file came from	Every file is linked to its web address and to its source in our catalogue.
Never edit originals by hand	All analysis works on copies; we can prove every original is unchanged.
Make it repeatable	The whole collection can be repeated at any time, picking up only new releases.

3. What we collected

Public finance

Dataset	Published by	Period	Use
Monthly Key Indicators	Accountant General, Bihar	Every month, Apr 2021 – Jun 2026	Receipts, spending and borrowing against the budget, month by month
Finance Accounts and Appropriation Accounts	Accountant General, Bihar	2021-22 to 2024-25	Audited annual accounts, in full detail
Accounts at a Glance	Accountant General, Bihar	2024-25	Summary of the year's audited accounts
Economic Survey	Finance Department	2024-25	Review of the economy, including district GDP
Green Budget	Finance Department	2024-25	Spending on environmental objectives
State Finance Commission reports	State Finance Commission	5th and 6th Commissions	Sharing of state revenue with panchayats and municipalities
GST statistics	GST Network	2017-18 to 2026-27	GST collected in each state
Finance Commission reports and data	15th and 16th Finance Commissions	2020-21 to 2030-31	Bihar's share of central taxes; Commission's evaluation of Bihar
PRS Budget Analysis	PRS Legislative Research	2026-27	Independent analysis of the budget

Population and social indicators

Dataset	Published by	Period	Use
Census tables	Registrar General of India	Census 2011	Population, literacy, work, housing, caste and tribe, by district
District Census Handbooks	Registrar General of India	Census 2011	Every district and every village, including village facilities
Sample Registration System	Registrar General of India	2011 to 2024	Birth, death, infant mortality and fertility rates
Population projections	Technical Group, Health Ministry	2011 to 2036	Official projections
Vital Statistics of India	Registrar General of India	2023	Registered births and deaths

Appendix A lists all 41 sources with their status.

4. Can the data be trusted?

Every file is an official government publication, kept exactly as downloaded. For each one we record the web address, the date and time, and a unique check code that proves the file has not changed since. Files that turned out not to be genuine (for example, 368 RBI files that were really an error page) were identified and set aside.

Cross-checks

Year	Revenue receipts: monthly accounts	Revenue receipts: audited accounts	Revenue deficit: monthly accounts	Revenue deficit: Economic Survey
2021-22	158,797	158,797	422	422
2022-23	172,688	172,688	11,288	11,288
2023-24	193,347	193,347	surplus 2,833	surplus 2,833
2024-25	218,658	218,657	357	not in this edition
2025-26	233,962	not yet published	24,785	not in this edition

Rs crore. The three sources agree for every year where they overlap; a difference of 1 is rounding (for example, 218,657.83 shown as 218,658).

Where to be careful

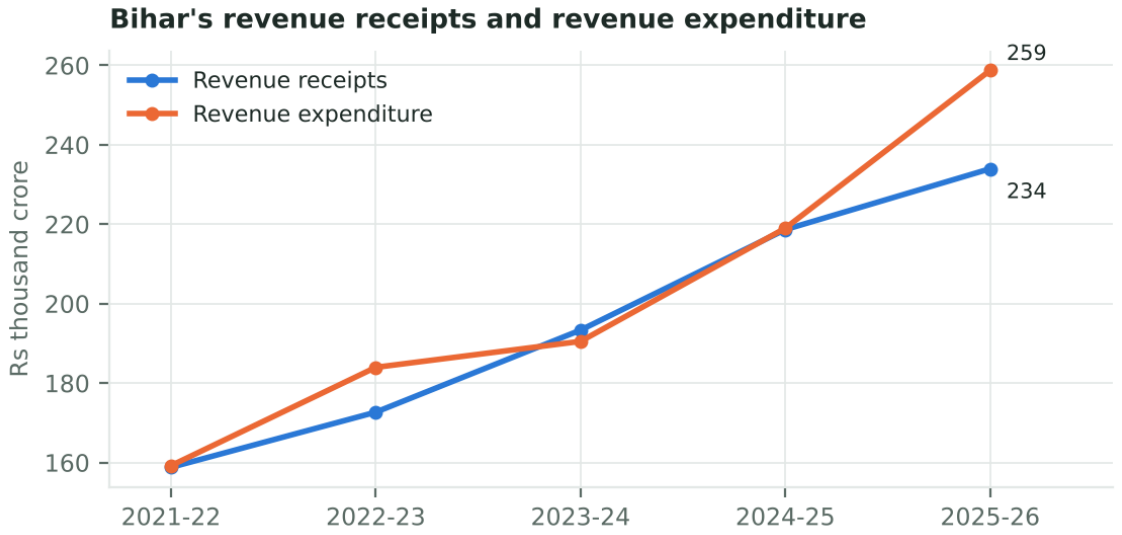
- **Monthly figures are provisional.** The Monthly Key Indicators are unaudited; the audited accounts follow about nine months after the year ends.

- **Some reports are scanned images.** About 2,400 pages, including the whole Economic Survey, were scanned. We made them searchable by having the computer read the page images, but this makes mistakes (for example, dropping minus signs), so any figure taken from them must be checked against the original page.
- **Bihar has several population figures.** Census 2011 counted 10.41 crore; the 2023-24 official estimate is 12.79 crore; the 2022-23 caste survey counted 13.07 crore. Any per-person figure must say which one it uses.
- **National files cover all states.** GST and Finance Commission data include every state; Bihar's figures need to be picked out.

5. A first look at Bihar's finances

The state's own monthly accounts give a consistent picture for 2021-22 to 2025-26. These are the year-end figures, unaudited for the latest year.

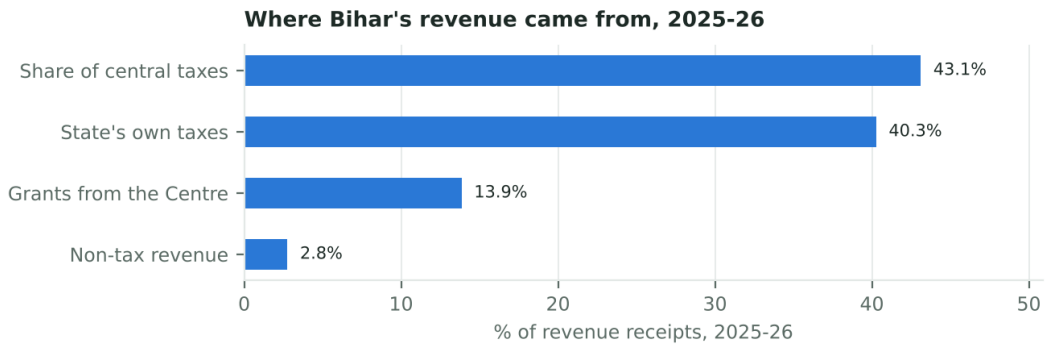
Rs crore	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26
Revenue receipts	158,797	172,688	193,347	218,658	233,962
of which: state's own taxes	60,297	71,007	82,838	91,381	94,221
of which: share of central taxes	65,910	68,521	79,127	91,632	100,871
of which: grants from the Centre	28,606	29,026	26,125	29,863	32,417
Revenue expenditure	159,220	183,976	190,514	219,015	258,748
of which: salaries and wages	24,983	26,290	30,047	40,456	57,632
of which: pensions	20,258	23,108	24,291	26,140	29,134
of which: interest	13,822	15,184	17,584	19,678	22,188
Capital expenditure	23,678	31,520	36,453	38,527	36,590
Revenue surplus (+) / deficit (-)	-422	-11,288	2,833	-357	-24,785
Fiscal deficit (borrowing)	25,551	44,823	35,660	41,222	63,803



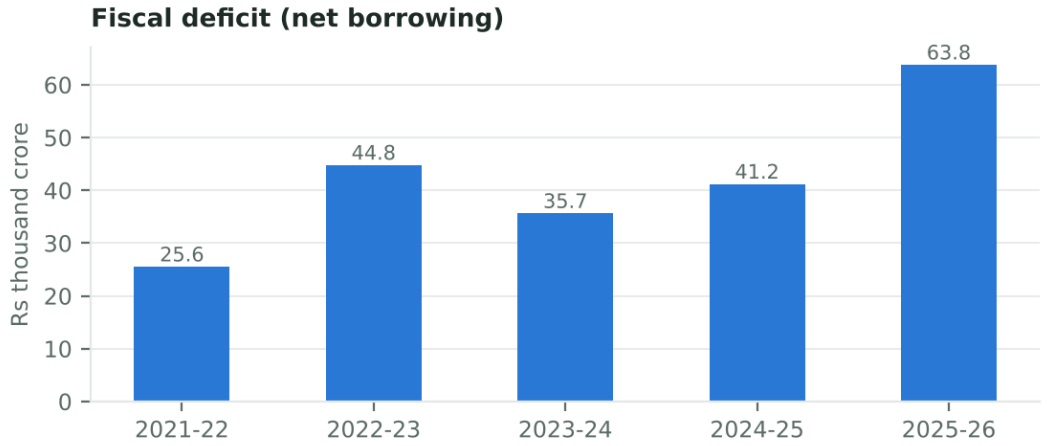
Revenue receipts and revenue expenditure, Rs thousand crore, 2021-22 to 2025-26.

What stands out

- **Revenue is growing, but spending grew faster in 2025-26.** Revenue receipts rose about 10% a year. In 2025-26 revenue expenditure jumped to Rs 258,748 crore, turning a near balance into a revenue deficit of Rs 24,785 crore. A revenue deficit means borrowing is paying for day-to-day spending, not only for investment.
- **Committed costs are taking a larger share.** Salaries, pensions and interest took 37% of revenue in 2021-22 and 47% in 2025-26. Salaries alone more than doubled, from Rs 24,983 crore to Rs 57,632 crore.
- **Borrowing rose sharply while investment stalled.** The fiscal deficit was Rs 63,803 crore in 2025-26, against Rs 41,222 crore a year earlier and 195% of the budgeted figure. Capital expenditure was Rs 36,590 crore, below the year before.
- **The state depends heavily on the Centre.** 57% of revenue receipts in 2025-26 came from the state's share of central taxes and from central grants.



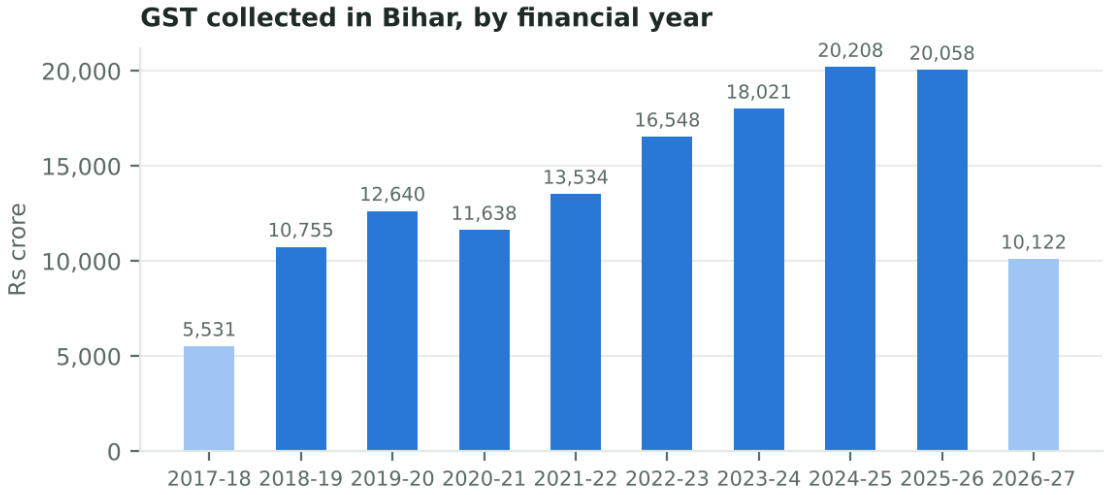
Where Bihar's revenue came from, 2025-26.



Fiscal deficit (net borrowing), Rs thousand crore.

6. GST and transfers from the Centre

GST collected in Bihar grew from Rs 10,755 crore in 2018-19 to Rs 20,058 crore in 2025-26. Bihar's share of GST collected across all states has stayed around 1.2%, ranking about 19th, although it has about 9.4% of the population. GST is collected mainly where businesses are registered and goods are produced.

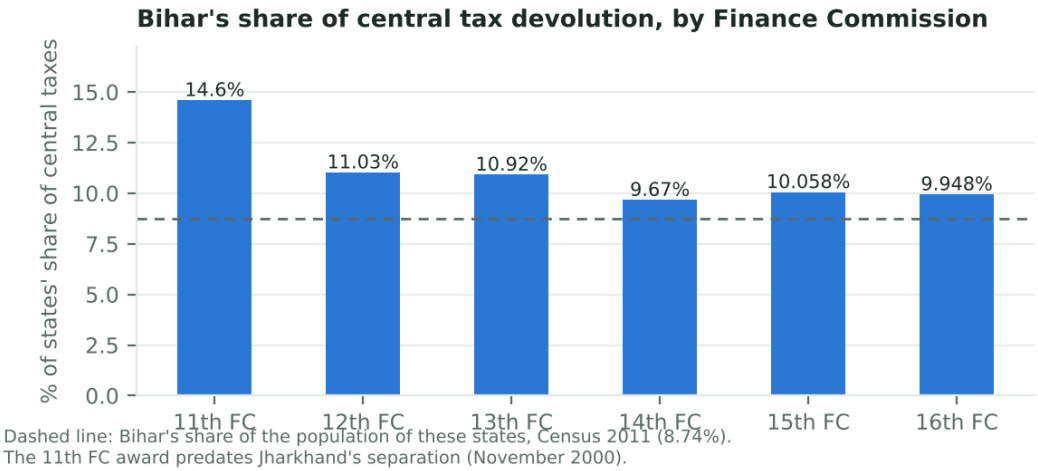


Light bars are part years: 2017-18 from July (GST began 1 July 2017); 2026-27 to September.

Source: GST statistics, state-wise collections by year.

The Finance Commission decides each state's share of central taxes. Bihar's share is 9.948% under the 16th Finance Commission (2026-31), slightly lower than 10.058% under the 15th. The Commission's own data explains why Bihar receives more than its population share: in 2023-24 Bihar had 9.42% of all states' population but 3.09% of their combined economy, and income per

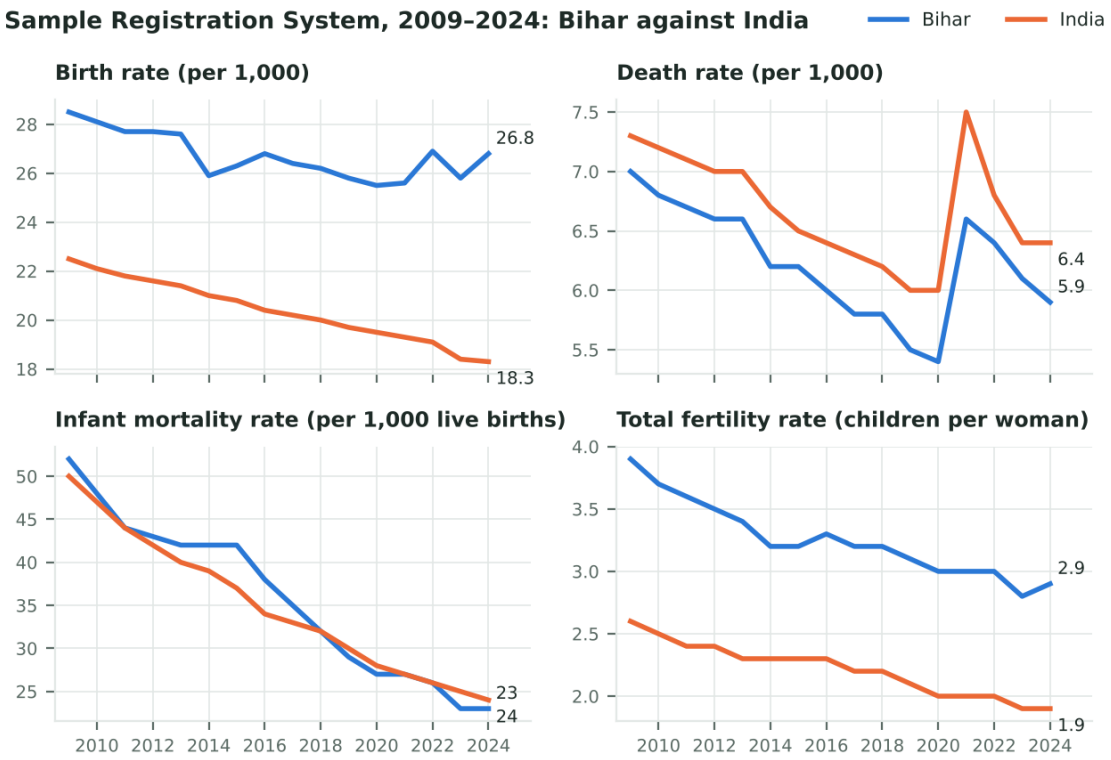
person of about Rs 68,009, roughly a third of the all-state average (Rs 207,113).



Source: 15th and 16th Finance Commission reports.

7. Population and social indicators

- **Population.** 10.41 crore at the 2011 Census; officially projected to reach 14.86 crore by 2036.
- **Health is improving.** Infant deaths fell from 52 to 23 per 1,000 births between 2009 and 2024, now level with India.
- **Families remain larger.** Women in Bihar have on average 2.9 children, against 1.9 for India; Bihar has the highest birth rate of the larger states. This means a young and growing population, with rising demand for schools and jobs.
- **Wide gaps between districts.** In 2011 literacy ranged from 51% in Purnia to 73% in Rohtas.
- **Village facilities in 2011.** Of 39,073 inhabited villages, 62% had household power, 69% an all-weather road and only 7% a bank. This is now 15 years old; the 2027 Census will update it.



Birth, death, infant mortality and fertility rates, Bihar and India, 2009–2024 (Sample Registration System).

8. What we could not collect yet, and why

Some sources could not be collected. None of this is lost work: each item can be added to the collection later, with the same records of where and when it was obtained.

Reason	Sources	What is needed
Website marked "not secure" (expired certificate)	Bihar budget documents; FRBM disclosures; NFHS	Download by hand until the websites are fixed
Website does not open from outside India, or was unreliable	Statistics directorate reports (district GDP, vital statistics, Statistical Handbook); CAG audit report	Repeat the collection from a computer in India
Website returned errors	CAG Monthly Civil Accounts and local-body audit reports	Retry later
Website only allows a person to download	RBI State Finances and Handbook; Open Budgets India	Download by hand
Login, form, "I am not a robot" check, or on-screen reports only	Treasury (CFMS), eGramSwaraj, labour and consumption surveys, health MIS, Mission Antyodaya, electoral statistics, SECC, Local Government Directory, DataLab, e-Statistics	Download or export by hand
No official link	Caste-based survey 2022-23 report	Obtain the tabled report

Four sources have nothing to collect: two departments publish only orders and notices, the Commercial Taxes Department publishes no data files, and Census 2027 results are not yet out.

9. Next steps

Step	What it involves	Benefit
1. Complete the Bihar collection	Repeat the collection from India; download the remaining sources by hand	Covers RBI data, budget documents, district GDP and health surveys
2. Clean and standardise	Put tables into consistent formats: district names, units, years	Data ready for comparison and analysis
3. Check key figures from scanned reports	Enter important tables (for example, from the Economic Survey) from the original pages	Reliable figures from image-only reports
4. Label every figure	Mark each number as reported, derived, estimated or unavailable	Transparency, as IBN's principles require
5. Connect the data	Per-person spending; district profiles against spending; health outcomes against health spending	The connected picture IBN aims for

10. Where to find everything

Everything is kept together in one online folder: **github.com/ayushjha4wd/ibn-collector**. It contains:

- This report.
- The **Bihar Data Book**: a detailed 40-page account of the data and what it shows.
- The **Bihar Data Handbook**: a short 16-page guide.
- A list of every file, with the period it covers, its size and where it came from.
- All the original government files, exactly as published, arranged by source.
- The tables behind the figures in this report, each traced to the page it came from.

The whole folder can be downloaded as a single file from the link above.

Appendix A. Status of all 41 Bihar sources

PF = public finance; DM = demographics; XC = directories and websites covering both.

ID	Source	Status	Notes
BR-PF-01	State Budget documents	Not yet	Web browsers mark the budget website as not secure (its security certificate has expired). Download by hand until the site is fixed.
BR-PF-02	Thematic budgets (green, gender, child, outcome)	Collected	Green Budget 2024-25. The website lists the others but provides no download links.
BR-PF-03	Fiscal Responsibility (FRBM) disclosures	Not yet	Same budget website as above.
BR-PF-04	Bihar Economic Survey	Collected	2024-25 edition, English and Hindi.
BR-PF-05	Finance Accounts, Appropriation Accounts, Accounts at a Glance	Collected	Audited accounts for 2021-22 to 2024-25.
BR-PF-06	Monthly Key Indicators and Monthly Civil Accounts	Partly	Monthly Key Indicators for every month April 2021 to June 2026. The Monthly Civil Accounts page was down.
BR-PF-07	CAG State Finances Audit Report	Not yet	The audit office's website does not open from outside India. Retry from India.
BR-PF-08	CAG audit reports on local bodies	Not yet	The audit office's page returned an error. Retry later.
BR-PF-09	State Finance Commission reports	Collected	5th and 6th Commission reports.
BR-PF-10	Treasury system (CFMS)	Needs a person	Requires a login.
BR-PF-11	Commercial Taxes Department revenue data	Nothing to collect	The department publishes no revenue data files; GST statistics and the monthly accounts cover this.
BR-PF-12	GST statistics	Collected	All states, 2017-18 to 2026-27.
BR-PF-13	RBI: State Finances, A Study of Budgets	Not yet	RBI's website only allows a person to download, one file at a time. Download by hand.
BR-PF-14	RBI: Handbook of Statistics on Indian States	Not yet	As above.
BR-PF-15	Finance Commission reports and data	Collected	15th and 16th Commissions, including the evaluation of Bihar's finances and the Commission's datasets.
BR-PF-16	PRS Bihar Budget Analysis	Collected	2026-27.
BR-PF-17	Open Budgets India	Needs a person	The website only allows a person to download by hand.
BR-PF-18	CityFinance (urban local bodies)	Needs a person	No files to download; part of its data is in the 16th Finance Commission datasets already collected.
BR-PF-19	eGramSwaraj (panchayat accounts)	Needs a person	Reports can only be viewed on screen.
BR-PF-20	Panchayati Raj Department	Nothing to collect	Publishes orders and notices, not data.
BR-PF-21	Urban Development Department	Nothing to collect	Publishes orders and notices, not data.
BR-PF-22	State and District GDP (statistics directorate)	Not yet	The statistics directorate's website was unreliable. District GDP is also in the Economic Survey, which was collected.
BR-DM-01	Caste-based survey 2022-23	Needs a person	No stable official link to the report.
BR-DM-02	Census 2011 tables for Bihar	Collected	500 tables.
BR-DM-03	District Census Handbooks 2011	Collected	All 38 districts, including every village.
BR-DM-04	Census 2027	Nothing to collect	Results not yet published.
BR-DM-05	Sample Registration System (births and deaths)	Collected	Annual reports 2011 to 2024.
BR-DM-06	Bihar vital statistics reports	Not yet	Statistics directorate website unreliable. Retry from India.
BR-DM-07	Monthly district birth and death returns	Not yet	As above.
BR-DM-08	Bihar Statistical Handbook	Not yet	As above.

ID	Source	Status	Notes
BR-DM-09	National Family Health Survey (NFHS)	Not yet	Web browsers mark the website as not secure (expired certificate).
BR-DM-10	Periodic Labour Force Survey	Needs a person	The ministry website does not offer direct downloads.
BR-DM-11	Household Consumption Expenditure Survey	Needs a person	As above.
BR-DM-12	Mission Antyodaya (village facilities)	Needs a person	Download form asks for name and purpose.
BR-DM-13	Socio Economic and Caste Census 2011	Needs a person	View-only website.
BR-DM-14	Electoral roll statistics	Needs a person	Published statistics must be saved by hand.
BR-DM-15	Health Management Information System	Needs a person	Reports are generated on screen.
BR-DM-16	Population projections 2011-2036	Collected	Official Technical Group projections.
BR-XC-01	Bihar DataLab	Needs a person	On-screen website only; data downloads are still planned.
BR-XC-02	Bihar e-Statistics website	Needs a person	Requires a login.
BR-XC-03	Local Government Directory	Needs a person	Download form has an "I am not a robot" check.

Appendix B. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Revenue receipts	Money the state receives that does not create a liability: its own taxes, its share of central taxes, grants and non-tax income
Revenue expenditure	Day-to-day spending: salaries, pensions, interest, subsidies, running costs
Capital expenditure	Spending that creates assets, such as roads, buildings and equipment
Revenue deficit	Revenue expenditure minus revenue receipts: borrowing used for day-to-day spending
Fiscal deficit	Total spending minus total receipts other than borrowing: the state's net borrowing for the year
Committed expenditure	Salaries, pensions and interest, which are hard to reduce in the short term
Budget estimate	The amount in the budget passed for the year
Devolution	The states' share of central taxes, divided among states by the Finance Commission
GSDP	Gross State Domestic Product: the size of the state's economy
Crore	10 million; Rs 1 lakh crore is Rs 1 trillion
Monthly Key Indicators	The Accountant General's monthly summary of the state's accounts
Infant mortality rate	Deaths before age one per 1,000 live births
Fertility rate	The average number of children a woman would have
Check code	A code worked out from a file's exact contents; if the file changed in any way, the code would change, which proves the file is unaltered